

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 8 6 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ 10

♣ J 8 6 3

♠ A

♥ J 7 4

♦ A K J 9 7 5

♣ A 7 4



♠ K 10 7 3

♥ K Q 10 6

♦ 3 2

♣ 10 9 5

♠ Q 5 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q 8 6 4

♣ K Q 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

4♦

Pass

5♦

All Pass

6♦ by North

Lead: ♥K

North is to play 6♦. East leads the ♥K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 1 ♥, 6 ♦s and 3 ♣s.

At first things look hopeless, but remember this is a lesson on squeeze plays. From the opening lead you know that East must hold the ♥Q. If he also holds the ♠K you will be able to squeeze him in ♥s and ♠s.

You let the ♥K win, (hoping he will play another ♥), but he plays a small trump instead which you win in your hand.

Pull one more round of trumps, then unblock the ♠A.

Then take your 3 ♣ winners, ending in your hand.

Now play ♦Q, ♦J, ♦9. Discard the ♠5 from dummy on the third ♦.

East could afford to throw 2 ♠s and a ♥ on your ♦ plays.

East discards the ♥10.

When you play the ♦7 he is squeezed.

He cannot dump his ♠K because you would throw the ♥8 and dummy would be high.

So he will discard the ♥10 instead. At this point you know that the ♠Q is worthless so you discard it. You win the final two tricks with the ♥A and ♥J.

Board 2
East Deals
None Vul

♠ 6 5 4 2
♥ J
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ J 10 9 3

♠ A K J
♥ K 7 3
♦ A 6 5 2
♣ 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 9 3
♥ 10 5 4
♦ K J 10
♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7
♥ A Q 9 8 6 2
♦ Q 7
♣ 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	4♥	1NT	2♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♣J			

your hand.

The ♦ Q was not a Threat card yet: to make it a Threat you had to unblock dummy's ♦ A. Then you pull trumps with the ♥ A Q.

Unblocking the ♦ A to make your ♦ Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to East.

Play the ♥ 9 8, discarding ♦ s from dummy. East is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦ J and the ♠ 3.

East is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

West discards.

Play the ♥ 6 and throw dummy's ♦ 6.

East can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠ 9 you will know that his ♠ Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦ K. So you would just play to the high ♠ s and the ♠ J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦ K which makes your ♦ Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦ A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥ 6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not East.

If you discard the ♦ 6 East will throw his ♦ J, then sit back and wait for his ♠ Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠ J instead, East will match that by throwing his ♠ 9, then sit back and wait for his ♦ K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♣ J. East wins ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

East takes ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

East opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and West has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠ Q and ♦ K are with East and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥ K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already rectified.

You plan to squeeze East by running the long ♥ s in

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 9 8 4 3
♥ 10 8 6 2
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ —

♠ Q 7

♥ A 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ A J 9 7 3 2

N
W E
S

♠ J 10 6 5

♥ K Q J 7 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 4

♠ A 2

♥ 9 3

♦ A K 8 6

♣ K Q 10 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4 ♥	Pass	4 ♠
Pass	6 ♣		
All Pass			

6 ♣ by North

Lead: ♥ K

♠ Q is the Vienna Coup.

East discards.

West was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣ 7 and discard dummy's ♠ 2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠ K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠ Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥ K.

North is to play 6♣. East leads the ♥ K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦ s also holds the ♠ K and that a squeeze will be possible.

You win the first trick and pull trumps in two rounds, ending in dummy.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you rectify the count by giving up a ♥.

East takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦ 9 which you win with your ♦ Q.

East plays low.

The key play: taking dummy's ♠ A before running three rounds of ♣ s.

Unblocking the ♠ A to create a Threat out of your

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9
 ♥ 10 5 3 2
 ♦ Q J 9 6 4 2
 ♣ 10 7

♠ A K Q 7 5 2

♥ 8 6 4

♦ 7 5

♣ 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 6
 ♥ 9 7
 ♦ 10 8 3
 ♣ J 9 8 4

♠ 4 3

♥ A K Q J

♦ A K

♣ A K Q 5 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

7NT by South

Lead: ♦ Q

North's 3NT rebid shows 6 ♠s headed by A K Q and nothing else. South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♦ Q.

Nice hand. You have 12 high card tricks and either a 3-2 ♠ split or a 3-3 ♣ split will land this Grand Slam. But even if neither suit splits nicely you can STILL make it if the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits; in that case you will squeeze for the thirteenth trick.

You win the ♦ K.

Win the ♦ K and (**IMPORTANT!**) test the ♣s first by playing ♣ A K Q. Darn. West discards a ♦ on the ♣ Q.

Alright, so East holds the ♣ Guard. You still need to exercise caution.

Play your 4 ♥ winner's next. West follows suit while East follows twice, then discards 2 ♦ s.

Don't play ♠s yet!

Play your ♦ A. East must give up.

If he throws the ♣ J, you win. But if he throws a ♠ you also win. This is what is called a Win-Win bridge play.

Board 5
West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 9 7 4 2
♥ J 4
♦ A 6 5 2
♣ 9 5 2

♠ A K Q J
♥ 9 5 3
♦ K Q
♣ 10 8 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5 3
♥ Q 10 7 2
♦ J 10 8 4
♣ 6 3

♠ 10 6
♥ A K 8 6
♦ 9 7 3
♣ A K Q J

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♦ J			

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♦ J. West takes the ♦ A and returns the ♦ 2.

Your 4 ♠ tricks, 2 ♥ tricks, 1 ♦ trick and 4 ♣ tricks are very easy to find. But that's only 11, so where in the world can you possibly find number 12?

With all those high ♦ s falling on the first two tricks dummy's ♦ 9 has become a threat against East. If it should happen that East also holds the only ♥ stopper you can squeeze him in the red suits.

You are going to run your black suit winners, taking the ♣ s first so you can be playing winners from your hand when you squeeze East.

On the last 2 ♣ s East discards a ♦ and a ♥.

Now come to your hand with the ♠ A and play the ♠ K Q.

You discard a small ♥ from dummy while East follows suit three times.

It is time.

East discards the ♥ 7, holding on to the ♦ 10.

Play your ♠ J and watch what East discards.

If he holds on to the ♦ 10 you will discard dummy's useless ♦ 9 and hope the ♥ s all fall under the ♥ A K.

If he discards the ♦ 10 then you throw dummy's small ♥ and dummy wins the last three tricks.